

Crossing the Abyss Game

This teaming exercise is designed to give the participants the experience of how they operate in a group, the strength of their intention and congruence, and how they respond to the moment-to-moment conditions of a situation. The exercise is also intended for the participants to demonstrate integrity and personal responsibility in their actions.

Set-up	Tape squares onto the floor (5ft by 20 ft).
Context and Purpose of the Game	Now it is time to ascend Mount Learning to 10,000 feet. [It will take us about 20 minutes of activity time, 12 hours simulated climbing time.] Because time is limited, we must move quickly, so let's get started! Remember, you're only as fast as your slowest teammate, so keep everyone in mind as you proceed. Every team member has a purpose and is vital to the success of your team.
Rules of the Game	[Instructor reads the rules out loud as participants read along in their workbooks. The Instructor's assistant disseminates the teams climbing supplies to team leaders while he reads rules.] 1. Once you begin climbing, there should be no talking. Discussions may only take place prior to the climb. 2. The floor has a series of taped squares depending on the number of teams. This square represents the abyss or the mountain to climb. 3. Each team receives three mats. These mats represent the only solid pieces of ground that can be climbed on. You cannot step on any space surrounding the mat, only the mats themselves. You will use these mats to cross the abyss . 4. You and your teammates will use whatever method you devise to manipulate these mats in climbing the mountain, but remember, you cannot talk with one another. 5. Find a climbing rectangle in the room and go to the side that is the Base Camp. [Give the teams sufficient time to convene on a game board.]

Does anyone have any questions before we begin? [Pause 5-10 seconds and respond to any questions.]

- END RULES -

[Start to play music.]

Ok, let's begin our climb. You have fifteen minutes.
[Instructor wanders through the room watching the teams climb. Quiet them if they are talking and if it continues, have them start the climb over.]

Debrief of Game

[Once the game finishes, proceed with the following discussion.]

Congratulations! You've reached Camp Learning.

Now that you are here, what did you discover about commitment? About teamwork?

What roles did people assume?

How did those roles manifest?

Who was not successful? Why/Why not?

Did anyone help another team?

[Take the discussion into what team is and responsibility for success.]